



Tehachapi First Baptist Church

**75th Anniversary
2017**

**75th ANNIVERSARY
CELEBRATION**

OCTOBER 15, 2017

1942 – 2017

**FIRST BAPTIST CHURCH
1049 SOUTH CURRY STREET
TEHACHAPI, CALIFORNIA**

Order of Service

Sunday, October 15th, 2017
75th Anniversary

Welcome | *Pastor John Lopez*

Speaker | *Harry Jasper*

Prayer

Speaker | *Randy Bennett*

Worship Through Song:

Greater is He That is in Me

How Great is Our God

How Great Thou Art

Speaker | *Don Ledbetter*

Hymns of Worship:

#334—*Blessed Assurance*

#330—*Amazing Grace*

Worship through giving

Special Music | *FBC Choir*

Message | *Jerry McCullah*

Hymn of Invitation:

#294—*Have Thine Own Way*

Benediction

Potluck



CURRENT PASTOR

John M. Lopez, Th.D

March 1, 2017

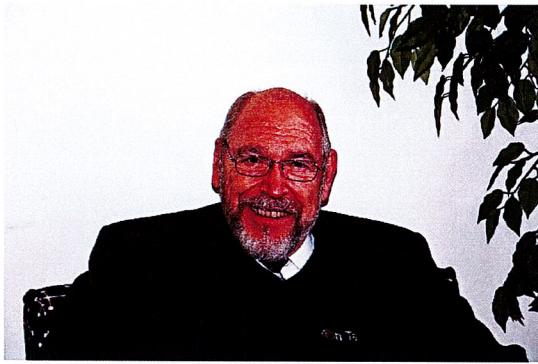
First Baptist Church welcomed John and his wife, Nita, on March 1, 2017. Nita is an accomplished musician and serves as Music Director.

We look forward to many years with John and Nita, serving God together in Tehachapi.

PASTORS

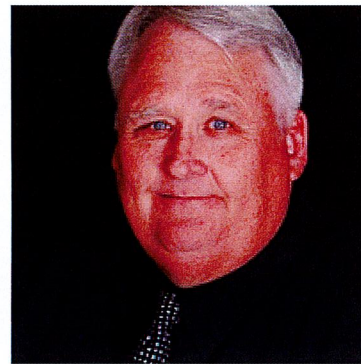
1942 THROUGH 2017

F. E. (Dick) Loving	1942 - 1943
R. E. Cure	1943 - 1944
John O. Hux	1945
Dave Chamblin	1945 - 1946
John L. Alexander	1946 - 1948
Homer D. Wilkes	1948 - 1950
T. Gordon Seibold	1950 - 1953
R. N. Blackwood	1954 - 1955
George Findley	1955 - 1962
R. Keith Lloyd	1962 - 1965
Raymond Roberson	1965 - 1971
Dexter Ogan	1972 - 1982
Phil Neighbors	1983 - 1985
Mike Chaney (Assistant)	1984 - 1985
James Trammell	1986 - 1988
Jerry McCullah	1988 - 1999
Larry Wood	1999 - 2001
Mark Vaughan	2001 - 2004
Ron Barker	2005 - 2015
John Lopez	2017 - ????



Bro. Jerry McCullah

October 5, 1988 - June 1, 1999



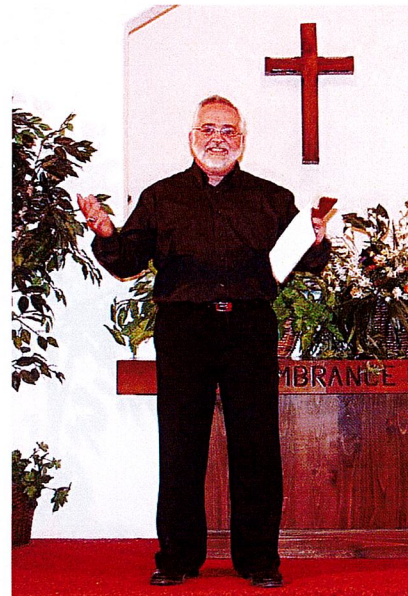
Bro. Larry Wood

August 8, 1999 - January 28, 2001



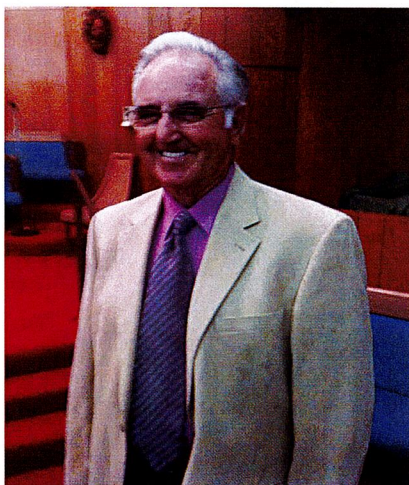
Bro. Mark Vaughan

August 19, 2001 - April 30, 2004



Bro. Ron Barker

June 4, 2005 - June 30, 2015



Dr. Don Ledbetter, Interim

April 1, 2016 - February 28, 2017

Former Pastors
who served during the past
25 years
1992 until 2017

THERE WERE EIGHT ORIGINAL CHARTER MEMBERS

DECEMBER 17, 1942

Everett Sims

Adalee Sims

Minnie Love

Bert McLaughlin

Ada Lee McLaughlin

Olin Collier

Vera Collier

Bobby Collier

**The Charter was extended for 60 days during which the following
members were added:**

George Johnson

Mahota Johnson

Cleo Green

Frank Collier

THE CHARTER CLOSED WITH TWELVE CHARTER MEMBERS

FEBRUARY 17, 1943

Everett Sims was saved in 1934 in his hometown of Mobeetie, Texas. He and his wife, Adalee, moved from Texas to Tehachapi in 1940 with their two daughters, Margie and Jean Ann. In 1941, their third daughter, Linda, was born and in 1947 they had a son, Harold. Everett and Adalee were both very instrumental in starting First Baptist Church along with six other people of like faith. In December, 1942, the church was started with eight members but the charter was extended until February, 1943 and four more members were added. When the charter closed, there were twelve members.

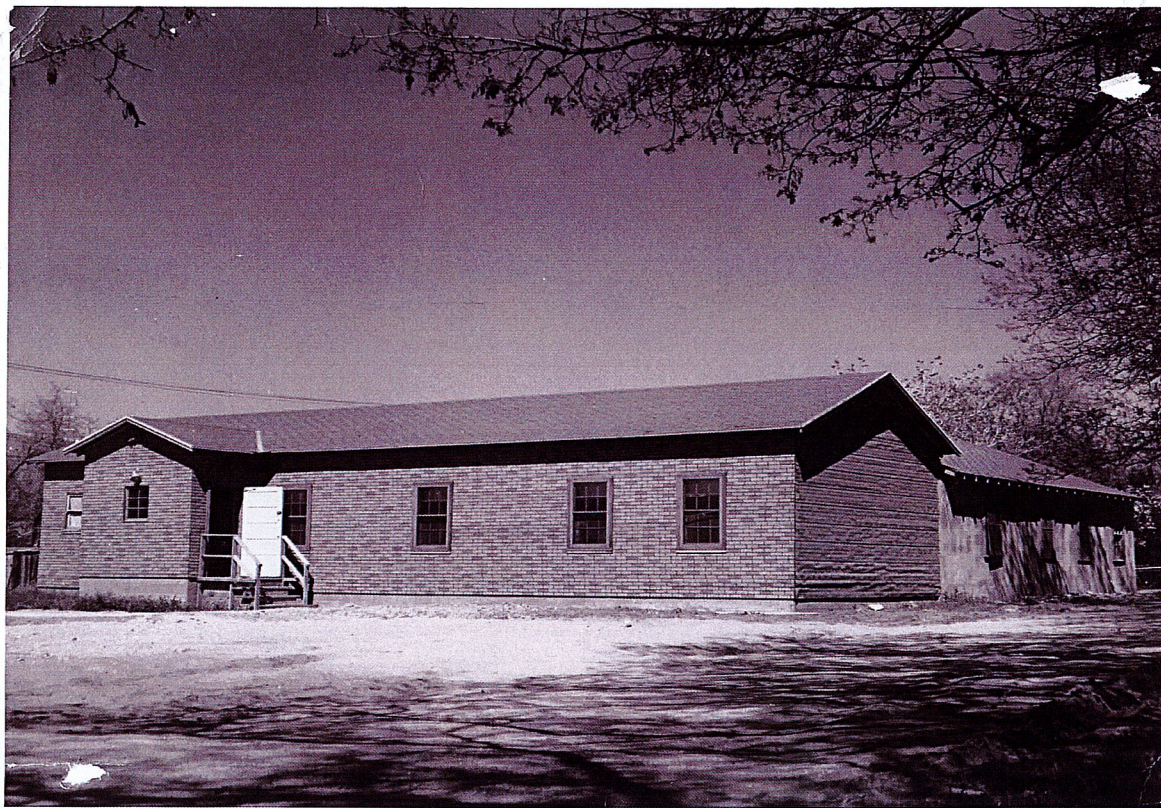
Everett has remained faithful in service to the church for the entire 75 years of its existence and has served as Deacon, Sunday School teacher, Trustee and choir member. His carpentry, plumbing and handyman skills have been put to good use on church buildings and he was always glad to be part of the work crew when things needed to be done.

He is the only remaining charter member of First Baptist Church. At the age of 102, he still faithfully attends church services and loves the Lord with all his heart, soul and mind.

CHARTER MEMBER

EVERETT SIMS





First church building - 1945





Second church building - 1956





Tehachapi News Article - By LaNelle Thompson

Published October 4, 2017

(Note: Article edited for inclusion in this booklet)

The First Baptist Church of Tehachapi will celebrate its 75th anniversary on Oct. 15. Former Pastor Jerry McCullah will be the special speaker along with Randy Bennett, area missionary for the California Southern Baptist Convention. The public is invited to join in the special worship service; lunch will follow the morning worship.

The church had its beginning in the spring of 1942 when a war with Japan was in progress, when sons, grandsons and other relatives were in the Armed Forces, and when Tehachapi did not have a Southern Baptist Church. A Northern Baptist Church, whose doctrine differs from the Southern Baptist, was begun at one time but it did not survive the pressures of the community.

Southern Baptist were worshiping with an established congregation of another faith. When that group began a concentrated building program, six women of Southern Baptist faith decided they could not endorse the fundraising and chose to form their own Women's Missionary Union. Because the California Southern Baptists were

having difficulty in establishing churches in California, they notified the group that they could not help financially, but did encourage the women to use the literature that was offered free of charge.

The women first met in the home of Minnie Love. Interest grew and soon the women initiated a Sunday school. The first meeting had 22 in attendance and an offering of \$18. They continued to meet in homes; however, they soon outgrew the homes and moved on to renting space in various locations.

There was just one problem — the community leaders would not endorse a Southern Baptist Church, they felt the city had enough churches. The existing churches were the Community Church, the Apostolic Church and the Catholic Church.

Not to be deterred, the believers met in December of 1942 in the basement of the Juanita Hotel for \$25 a month. (Note: The hotel was later demolished in the 1952 earthquake and is today the site of Gallery 'N' Gifts on Tehachapi Boulevard.) They bought 20 chairs from the Community Church, a used piano from a music store in Bakersfield and 25 song books and a communion service that was left behind by the Northern Baptists. They were in business. However, as the congregation grew, so did the problem of finding meeting places. As an example, one pastor was refused a place to rent, but when he took a job in town as a mechanic, it was only then that he found a home to rent.

Leaders of the church were very foresighted; they bought property in one location and later sold it and bought the property at 414 So. Curry St. Lumber was bought from the government and excess lumber was sold in order to continue the building program. Some of the first buildings and lumber came from the Japanese Concentration Camp (Manzanar) at Lone Pine after the war.

The church progressed from the 414 Curry location to the present location at 1049 So. Curry St. The church has always prided itself in having a debt-free church and in supporting the So. Baptist Convention's Cooperative Program which funds missions programs.

On Dec. 17, 1942, 8 members brought their letters from their home churches in Oklahoma, Tennessee and Texas, among others, to become the first charter members of the Tehachapi Southern Baptist Church. They were Olin and Vera Collier and son Bobby, Everett and Adalee Sims, Bert and Ada Lee McLaughlin and Minnie Love. The charter was extended for 60 days during which four more members were added: George & Mahota Johnson, Cleo Green and Frank Collier. The charter closed with twelve members. Everett Sims is still a member of the church; he will celebrate his 103rd birthday in November.

The church has, like any democratic body, had its trials. Twenty pastors have come and gone. Some could be described as "overnighters" with their very short stay, but some went on to other jobs, some returned to their home states, some returned to school or seminary and some retired from the ministry. Each left a footprint in helping the church to become what it is today.

In researching, one can always find interesting and little-known facts about the organization. There are many, but these are very noteworthy:

- The first parsonage built in 1946 was built with lumber from the Manzanar Japanese Concentration Camp located near Lone Pine.
- The first pastor was paid \$10 a week.
- In 1942, the church met in a bar. Members had to go in early on Sunday morning and clean up the room before services.
- The property where the present church was built cost \$11,000. Property at the first location cost \$1,600; the owner donated \$500 to the church.
- Our country was at war with Japan in 1942. Most members had sons and grandsons in the armed services. Women in the church made a silk prayer flag with a white background and a red border. A blue star for each serviceman was placed on the flag with a promise to pray for each man at a certain time each Sunday morning. The flag with 19 stars was dedicated on Easter morning in 1942. A relative of the serviceman removed a cover over the name, and stood to offer a silent prayer for the loved one. Many people who never attended worship services elsewhere in Tehachapi asked that the name of their loved ones be added to the flag. Of 35 stars, not one blue star turned to gold.

The first service in the present sanctuary was held on Feb. 21, 1982, with a dedication held on March 7, 1982. The furnishings were debt-free soon after the dedication.

At the time of this writing, the church continues to follow God's leading under the direction of Pastor John Lopez. His wife, Nita Lopez, an immensely accomplished musician, is in charge of the music ministry. William Hunt, Kent Winterrowd and Harry Jasper are support staff and contact persons for questions and counseling. Dolly Johnson heads the Church Hostess Committee, and Rich Johnson serves the church as the audio sound man. Linda Stivers serves as Church Clerk and Treasurer. Sue Weinberg is the chairperson for the Women's Ministry.